DATA://01

The Honest Cost

...of running an AI agency in 2026

SWIPE →

DATA://REAL

Gurus don't show you their P&L.

I will.
Here's what it actually costs to run a lean AI agency.

$387

Total fixed costs per month
(everything, not just 'tools')

INFRA

01

HOSTING

Vercel · Hostinger · Hetzner VPS for n8n
Total: $47/mo

VARIABLE

02

AI APIs

Claude API · OpenAI · Gemini Flash
Total: $120/mo (averaged)

03

SAAS (ESSENTIAL ONLY)

GitHub Pro · Notion · Calendly · 1Password
Total: $75/mo

04

DOMAINS + EMAIL

3 domains + Google Workspace
Total: $45/mo

05

MARKETING

Ads · Cold email tool
Total: $100/mo (fluctuates)

AVOIDED

06

WHAT I DON'T PAY FOR

Office. CRM. HR. Lawyers on retainer.
Slack. Zoom. 90% of SaaS.

$387 IN

vs. $12K+ out
That's the agency margin game

RECAP

THE LESSONS

- Costs scale with ego, not revenue
- Every 'essential SaaS' can be replaced
- Variable costs > fixed costs
- Tools after revenue, not before
- Your biggest cost is the one you waste

WHAT'S YOUR P&L?

Comment 'RUNWAY' for my full breakdown PDF.
Save this as your audit.

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